

Student Research Opportunities

The Cultivating Interest in Research Careers (CIRC) program with UCLA and Charles R. Drew University of Medicine and Science (CDU)

The Cultivating Interest in Research Careers (CIRC) program is a partnership between University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) and Charles R. Drew University of Medicine and Science (CDU). The program starts with a ten-week summer research program at UCLA and extends into a year-long continuum. The goal of CIRC is to provide community college students underrepresented in medicine and science (UIMS), such as African American, Latinx, Native American, Pacific Islander, disabled and socioeconomically disadvantaged students, with hands-on exposure and training in scientific research aligned with the scientific mission of the NHLBI.

The CIRC program will provide these community college students with educational workshops, near-peer mentoring, and skills to help them transfer to a 4-year college or university and ultimately be prepared to pursue a health profession or scientific research career. View additional benefits included a stipend of at least

\$4,800 <https://www.uclahealth.org/departments/medicine/internal-medicine/research/research-programs/cultivating-interest-research-careers#about>

Application Requirements

- Official Academic Transcript
- Two Letters of Recommendation : One from an Instructor
- Completed Application

Application: https://cduhi.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_cvWkYswnsnCLwKG and email completed package to: circprogram@cdrewu.edu

Program Website: <https://www.uclahealth.org/departments/medicine/internal-medicine/research/research-programs/cultivating-interest-research-careers>

Deadline: Sunday, February 16, 2026

Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible to participate in the CIRC Program, students must meet the following eligibility requirements:

Either:

- A current high school senior who has taken at least a semester of community college classes and plans on transferring to a community college in the Fall

OR

- Current community college student attending a community college in Los Angeles County (Must have at least a year of classes to complete before transferring to a four-year college or university) attending a community college in Los Angeles County
- US citizen or permanent resident
- Have taken at least one college course in the general domains listed below:
 - Oral Communication
 - Written Communication
 - Critical Thinking
 - Mathematics/Quantitative Reasoning
- Have a composite grade point average of 3.2 or above in this coursework.

For more information, contact circprogram@cdrewu.edu

UC San Diego Summer Training Academy for Research Success (STARS)

The University of California, San Diego Summer Training Academy for Research Success (STARS) program is an eight-week summer research academy for community college students, undergraduate students, recent college graduates, and master's students. Open to all disciplines, STARS offers student participants a rigorous research opportunity with esteemed UC San Diego faculty, informative transfer and graduate school preparation workshops, and educational, cultural, and social activities in sunny San Diego. The program also offers a stipend and housing on UC San Diego's campus free. Must be US citizen, Permanent Resident or AB 540

Program Website: <https://grad.ucsd.edu/oar2/oar2office/programs/undergraduate-programs/stars/index.html#eligibility>

Application: <https://grad.ucsd.edu/oar2/oar2office/programs/undergraduate-programs/stars/stars-application.html#begin-your-stars-application>

Project Descriptions: <https://grad.ucsd.edu/oar2/oar2office/programs/undergraduate-programs/stars/twentsixproject-descriptions.html#STARS%202026%20-%20Research%20Project%20Descriptions>

Flyer: <https://www.instagram.com/p/DRz4Ueej4p0/>

Deadline: Rolling admissions until March 2, 2026, but priority deadline was January 12, 2026

Program Dates: June 21st to August 14th

For questions or additional information please review the [STARS Program FAQ](#) or email urstars@ucsd.edu.

Capital One Launchpad: Legacy & Leadership Program

Selected scholars will participate in a fully expensed five-day immersion experience along with 50 students from the Thurgood Marshall College Fund (TMCf). The joint immersion experience is focused on career exploration and professional development. Students will have the opportunity to work directly with designated Capital One associates who will guide them toward a final capstone presentation that will conclude the week's events. \$1,000 stipend will also be administered to the students who complete the Immersion Experience. Travel, lodging, and meal expenses will be fully covered for all selected participants.

HACU students selected to attend the Immersion Experience are also sponsored to attend the ¡Adelante! Leadership Institute at HACU's 40th Annual Conference, October 30 – November 2, 2026, at the Gaylord Pacific Resort & Convention Center in Chula Vista, California.

Program Website and Application: <https://hacu.net/programs/capital-one-launchpad-program/>

Deadline: March 16, 2026

Program Dates: July 13 – 17, 2026 in McLean, Virginia

Eligibility

- Must be a rising sophomore or junior
- Must have a minimum cumulative Grade Point Average of 3.0
- Must attend a TMCf or HACU-affiliated college or university (SMC is listed in the membership directory)
- Must be available to travel and fully engage in the immersion from 07/13/2026 – 07/17/2026
- Must be a U. S. Citizen

This opportunity is designed for students interested in one of the following **Business or Technology** career paths:

- Business Administration, Business Management, Business Analytics, Business Information Systems, Finance, Commercial Banking, and other business majors.
- Data Analytics, Computer Science, Technology Management, Information Technologies, and other tech majors.

Make sure your resume and application reflect this:

Leadership and Initiative:

- Proven participation in and leadership of campus activities or comparable groups.
- Demonstrated ability to take initiative and lead by example in various settings.

Relevant Experience:

- Engagement in projects that directly relate to your area of interest.
- Participation in hackathons, case competitions, and campus extracurricular activities.
- Completion of academic projects or internships that align with Capital One's field of work.

Analytical and Quantitative Skills:

- Strong analytical abilities with a solid foundation in quantitative reasoning.
- Exceptional problem-solving skills and conceptual thinking.

Louisiana State University School of Veterinary Medicine (LSU Vet Med) in Baton

Rouge, Louisiana, is offering paid 10-week summer research internships to undergraduate and recent post-baccalaureate students. Research topics include toxicology, heart disease, lung biology, immunology, infectious diseases, neuroscience, and more. Students will receive mentorship in research and career planning in a multi-disciplinary and collaborative environment. This opportunity is open to 6 to 10 students annually, depending on funding availability and qualified applicant-mentor matching. Applicants can explore opportunities in any of LSU Vet Med's three departments: **Comparative Biomedical Sciences**, **Pathobiological Sciences**, and **Veterinary Clinical Sciences**.

All participants will receive a stipend for the 10-week program, university housing, and a meal plan. Some travel expenses may be reimbursed, up to \$500. Students will be connected to summer researchers in other colleges/departments within the university through the Office of Undergraduate Research, which creates social programs for summer researchers. All LSU Vet Med summer researchers will receive career mentorship from program mentors and administrators.

All undergraduate students currently enrolled in any U.S. college or university as well as recent postbaccalaureate candidates who are U.S. citizens, permanent residents, or possess student or exchange visas (e.g. F-1, H1, H1B, J1, PR, or TN) are invited to apply. Preference will be given to students with a strong academic background in relevant STEM fields. Applications from students belonging to populations that are traditionally underrepresented in the biomedical field are encouraged.

Note the program may start in late May, but applicants can state their limited availability as finals are in June for SMC students. If the selection committee is interested, they may permit partial term attendees with prorated stipend.

Priority deadline is February 1, 2026

Application and

Website: https://www.lsu.edu/vetmed/research/undergrad_summer_research.php

For more information, contact Stephen Costin, Ph.D., the Research and Graduate Education Manager at LSU School of Veterinary Medicine at scostin@lsu.edu.

-

The CCALAC Allied Health Internship Program will place up to 30 individuals in a paid 110-hour in-person internship at one of our member health centers within LA County. Internships will take place throughout the Spring and Summer of 2026. Prior to their internship, participants will participate in orientation, plus two fundamental workshops. Interns receive a \$1,500 stipend for completing the 110-hour requirement.

The goal of this internship is to recruit individuals who are job-ready and want to enter the role after completion of the internship if an offer is extended.

Note there are no CNA positions available.

Program Website: <https://ccalac.org/services/workforce/allied-health-internship-program/>

Application: <https://ccalac.org/services/workforce/allied-health-internship-program/allied-health-internship-program-application/>

Application Deadline: March 20, 2026 at 11:59 PM

Applicants Requirements:

- Complete and submit application
- Must be at least 18 years old
- Must attend Orientation and two virtual workshops
- Ability to complete a 110-hour in-person internship (approximately 15 – 25 hours a week over the course of 5-6 weeks)
- Availability Monday-Friday (for internship hours)
- Must be able to do internship hours between the hours of 8am-5pm
- Must live in Los Angeles County
- Must have reliable transportation to travel to and from internship clinic site
- Must be in the last 4-6 months of your program/area of study or have recently graduated. (However, they did note those who received degrees years ago can still apply if they are job ready.)

- Must be in one of the areas of study below
- Bilingual (Spanish) – not required, but a plus

International students with valid work authorization are welcome to apply. However, placement and employment opportunities vary by health center and job offers and visa sponsorships cannot be guaranteed. F-1 students should reach out to the SMC International Education Center to learn more about work authorization qualifications.

Accepted Areas of Study:

- Medical Assistant
- Licensed Vocational Nurse
- Community Health Worker
- Substance Abuse Counselor
- Patient Care Representative/Patient Navigator/Care Coordinator
- Behavioral Tech
- Pharmacy Tech
- Health Information Technology
- Billing and Coding
- Dental Assistant
- Dental Hygienist
- Phlebotomist
- Promotor/a
- Administrative – Customer Service, Reception, Call Center, etc.
- Undergraduate majors – Community Health, Behavioral Health, Health Education, Social Work, Health Administration

For more information, attend the upcoming Allied Health Internship Program – Applicant Informational Session on January 29, 2026 from 12pm – 1pm via Zoom <https://us02web.zoom.us/meeting/register/FeBGRuetRJ2EsW7PAe2oHg> and/or contact recruitment@ccalac.org

Apply for the NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU) in Computational Analysis of Infectious Diseases at Yale University, a paid 10-week summer research program designed to support formerly incarcerated undergraduate students interested in computational analysis and public health. Participants are matched with faculty mentors, receive computational training, and present their research at the end of the program. Community college students are encouraged to apply. Applicants must be a US citizen or permanent resident. Housing near Yale campus will be provided at no cost to the student.

Program Website: <https://yalecollege.yale.edu/finances/financial-awards-prizes/nsf-research-experience-undergraduates-reu-computational-analysis>

Deadline: March 1, 2026

Program Dates: Starting in June and ending by the first week of August.

Application: <https://yale.communityforce.com/Funds/FundDetails.aspx?496F49596D593768464E3537506B6F754D5442315A3472387A324F446B683737666B672B446258686146586B41366A704135597931677151503066576431355663684D4A6466364F6668593D>

For more questions, reach out to Jacqueline Tanaka at jacqueline.tanaka@yale.edu

LA HACKS 2026

LA Hacks is a student-run 36-hour annual hackathon at UCLA, welcoming 1000+ participants each year to create innovative solutions to modern problems. LA Hacks strives to provide an innovative and inviting space for students of all majors, ethnicities, gender identities, and backgrounds. They aim to inspire hackers to create projects that solve modern problems while creating a space that encourages diversity, collaboration, and learning. Join them April 24-26, 2026 at UCLA's Pauley Pavilion.

All students of all majors are welcome! This includes university undergrads, graduate students, and high school students. Hackathons are great for all coders, designers and creative thinkers who are passionate about solving a problem. Whether you're building your first website, dabbling in Photoshop, or making the next cryptocurrency, LA Hacks has a place for you.

Website and Track Ideas: <https://lahacks.com/>

General deadline to apply: February 20, 2026

Questions? DM at [@lahacks](#) or email info@lahacks.com

Cal-Bridge Summer Program

Cal-Bridge Summer is a summer research program designed to allow California State University and California Community College students to participate in cutting-edge research in a variety of STEM disciplines at one of over 20 world-class partner research institutions.

Program Website: <https://calbridge.org/summer-program/>

Application: <https://calbridge.secure-platform.com/summerprogram/>

Deadline: February 2, 2026, by 11:25 am PT

Eligibility Requirements

To be eligible for Cal-Bridge Summer, an applicant must be:

1. At least 18 years of age by the beginning of the program
2. Enrolled in either a CSU or a California Community College
3. Have a major and/or career goals in Physics & Astronomy, Computer Science & Computer Engineering, Mathematics & Statistics, or a related field
4. Be a U.S Citizen, Permanent Resident, or AB540/DACA

Application Information

1. Required application information includes:
 1. Contact info (address, email, cell phone)
 2. Academic information (major, overall GPA, etc.)
 3. Personal Statement (500 words)
 4. Undergraduate transcripts (unofficial transcripts accepted; please do not upload password-protected documents)
2. Letters of recommendation from two (2) faculty members must be obtained.
 1. Contact your letter writers early to obtain their consent to write a letter
 2. You must provide their names and email addresses in your application
 3. Important note: the system automatically sends an email to your recommenders, and this email may automatically filter into their junk mail folder. Please follow up with your recommenders to make sure they have received the email from us to submit their letters.

For questions, contact the Cal-Bridge Summer program at SummerProgram@calbridge.org.

2026 CHIPS Fellows Application at USC

The CHIPS Technician Fellows program at the University of Southern California (USC) introduces diverse participants to cleanrooms, equipment, and processes to prepare them for careers in the fast-growing semiconductor and microelectronics industry. No prior technician experience necessary.

The program will be held **February 20th to February 27th** for a total of 6 weekday sessions. The program will take place on **USC's campus from 8:30 am - 5 pm PT**. All participants who complete the entire program will be **paid a \$1,600 stipend**.

Please view [HERE](#) for more background on the program.

Background information on semiconductor technician career pathways can be found [here](#).

To be eligible for this program, applicants must meet the following criteria:

1. Ability to commute to the University of Southern California (USC) campus daily.
2. Prior work experience in a field using your hands.
3. Expressed interest in the semiconductor and microelectronics industry.
4. Willingness and ability to learn and adhere to cleanroom work and safety protocols.
5. High school diploma, GED, or community college background. Not currently enrolled in a bachelor's or graduate degree program.
6. Age 18 or older
7. Strong motivation to transition directly into the semiconductor industry and demonstrated job search readiness.
8. Fluency in English.

For more information, contact Workforce Coordinator - Dr. Jalil Bishop - MUME Collective at jbishop1291@gmail.com

The Proctor Foundation for Art and Science will be sending a total of 8 community college students and faculty to Space Camp this summer. Space camp dates are July 10-12, 2026 with July 9 as a travel day.

Program Website: <https://proctor.foundation/>

Application: https://my.reviewr.com/s2/site/proctor_art_science_2026?redir=micrositedefaultsign

Deadline: February 28, 2026

Student Eligibility

- Students must be 18 years or older and enrolled full-time as a community college student.
- Students must be majoring in a STEAM (science, technology, engineering, art and mathematics) related subjects such as, but not limited to: literature, graphic design, music, poetry, creative writing, film or television production, immersive media, journalism, women's studies, gender studies, biology, chemistry, physics, computers, civil engineering, electrical engineering, mechanical engineering, or statistics.

Educator Eligibility

- Faculty must teach in a STEAM (science, technology, engineering, art and mathematics) related subject such as, but not limited to: literature, graphic design, music, poetry, creative writing, film or television production, immersive media, journalism, women's studies, gender studies, biology, chemistry, physics, computers, civil engineering, electrical engineering, mechanical engineering, or statistics.
- Community college faculty must be full-time at an accredited community college in the United States.
- Applicants must live in the United States full-time or part-time and must have legal documentation to reside in the United States.

The scholarship includes travel limited to a \$1,000 or less airfare stipend, meals, lodging, education materials, and more.

For questions about Space Camp or issues with your application, please email emilyp@spacecamp.com.

I wanted to share this opportunity to faculty or administrators who might be interested in mentoring a team of 2-4 students from SMC. Interdisciplinary teams that include students in STEM, business, humanities, and other fields are encouraged. Only 3 teams can apply per community college. The finalist teams will receive a full travel support to attend the Innovation Bootcamp in DC in June 2026.

Student teams are asked to develop a STEM solution to real-world problems of local to global concern. A team will be required to:

- Identify a problem of local to global concern that you seek to address with your STEM innovation.
- Assess your innovation's potential impact on society (such as on the economy, national security, global competitiveness, the environment, quality of life, etc.).
- Determine the scientific and market feasibility of the innovation, identifying any challenges and ways to potentially work through them.
- Share ideas for how the innovation would be implemented in a real-world scenario. Start thinking of yourselves as entrepreneurs with a novel invention, creation, or product you want to bring to the marketplace

For more information, visit <https://www.aaccinnovationchallenge.com/about-the-ccic/>

Upcoming Info Sessions <https://www.aaccinnovationchallenge.com/vet-your-idea/>

Past Winners and Project Ideas: <https://www.aaccinnovationchallenge.com/guidebook-resources/past-ccic-winners/>

Application Deadline: April 3, 2026 at 11:59 PM PDT

STEM Poster Design Workshop

Presented by Jessie F. Salter, Ph.D., Assistant Professor, Life Sciences

This virtual Zoom workshop will give you the tools and strategies to design an academic STEM poster that communicates your research effectively to the public. You will learn the key components of a STEM research poster, basic design principles and strategies for speaking clearly and compellingly about your work—including tips for answering questions with confidence.

Thursday, April 2, 2026

11:30 a.m. - 12:30 p.m. PT

Join us virtually!

Zoom Registration at: <https://smc-edu.zoom.us/meeting/register/cP3mUMGjRT-Wwlu7DI7Vmg#/registration>

Event Flyer: <https://acrobat.adobe.com/id/urn:aaid:sc:US:6d5cd0ed-f20d-471a-a766-efffeb296cec>

SMC students are also invited to present your STEM research at our inaugural STEM Poster Symposium on May 15, 2026. Share your STEM research from your class projects, independent studies, internships, or research experiences with your peers, faculty, staff, and more. Apply to present by: April 24, 2026 at <https://forms.office.com/r/KbhhwxFnmy>.

If you need an accommodation due to a disability, please email dsps@smc.edu or call (310) 434-4265 at least 5 business days prior to the event.

This event is a collaboration among SMC STEM Academic Departments, the STEM MÁS Program, and the Career Services Center, with funding provided by the SMC Foundation Northrop Grumman/Elkin Chair of Excellence in Physical Science and the STEM MÁS grant. For additional information, please contact stemposters@smc.edu or visit the event website at: <http://www.smc.edu/stem/posters>.

Amgen Speaker Series: Building the Next Generation of Scientists — Skills, Networks, and Mindsets for What's Next

Led by SMC Physical Sciences, with support from the Career Center and funding from the STEM MÁS grant

April 7, 2026

11:30 a.m. – 12:30 p.m. PT

Life and Physical Science Complex (SCI), Room 140

Speaker: René Hubert

Scientific Director, Early Career Talent and Academic Engagement

B.S. Biochemistry and a Ph.D. in Molecular Biology

René is a proud Trojan, having earned his Ph.D. in Molecular Biology from USC in 1993. After completing his postdoctoral training at Cedars-Sinai, he embarked on a more than 25-year career in the Los Angeles biotech ecosystem, with roles at Agensys, Xencor, Osmetech, and Amgen. Across these organizations, his work has focused on advancing antibody-based therapeutics and enabling technology innovations that help turn scientific insight into medicines.

Over the past eight years at Amgen, René has held leadership roles in Research, including leading the Expression and Cell Engineering group within Protein Engineering. Today, his focus is firmly on the future—developing early-career scientific talent and connecting Amgen with academic innovation through outreach efforts, post-baccalaureate programs, and graduate fellowships.

René believes that the future of biotechnology lies not only in discovery, but in the people who make discovery possible.

For additional information about this event, please contact Joan Kang at kang_joan@smc.edu.

Event Flyer Link: <https://acrobat.adobe.com/id/urn:aaid:sc:us:ed30253a-d9d9-454a-89b8-01a09904a407>

If you need an accommodation due to a disability, please email dsps@smc.edu or call (310) 434-4265 at least 5 business days prior to the event.

My name is Elizabeth Leon Garcia, and I serve as the Project Coordinator for **EMBARC** (Educational Modules to Broaden Academic Research Cultures) housed at the **CSUN Health Equity Research and Education (HERE) Center**. We are a program grounded in Community Cultural Wealth (CCW) which emphasizes the importance of students' cultural strengths as they navigate STEMM fields.

EMBARC supports students across **a wide range of STEMM** and related majors, including social and behavioral sciences. Example majors are listed in an attached flyer, but **all students interested in research** are welcome.

We're excited to announce that EMBARC is now accepting applications for our **Health Equity Summer Institute**, taking place **June 14th to June 18th!**

This, **PAID, five-day immersive experience** offers students a unique opportunity to build skills, explore research, and connect with CSUN research faculty.

Participants will receive:

- **Free on-campus housing at CSUN** for the full five-day summer program
- **All meals provided** throughout their stay
- **Engaging professional development workshops**
- **Networking opportunities with CSUN faculty and researchers**
- **Hands-on training to develop data skills**

The application deadline for our Health Equity Summer Institute is **March 31st at 11:59PM**

If you are interested in a 10-15 minute class presentation about this opportunity (in-person or virtual) by a Peer Navigator, please email requests to embarc@csun.edu.

We would greatly appreciate your support in sharing the attached EMBARC Health Equity Summer Institute flyer with your students and your campus community at Santa Monica College.

Students can access the application through our [flyer](#) or the link I have pasted here for reference: <https://bit.ly/EMBARC-SUMMER26>

Students interested in learning more are encouraged to register for one of our upcoming information sessions: <https://bit.ly/EMBARC-summerinfo-26>

Please feel free to reach out to us if you have any questions at embarc@csun.edu.

Additional details about EMBARC can be found on our [website](#).

On behalf of the UCLA Chicano Studies Research Center (CSRC), the Latina Futures 2050 Lab (Latina Futures), and the UCLA Division of Physical Sciences, I am emailing you to invite you and to ask you help us spread the word for our upcoming [Breaking Barriers in STEM Conference](#) at UCLA this April 17 and 18. This conference brings together students with professors, scholars, and researchers from all areas of chemistry and biochemistry to establish, strengthen, and promote research collaborations between scientists from partner institutions who are committed to broadening participation in STEM disciplines. All are welcome to attend!

Registration is free! We only ask attendees to pay for their own travel (the conference will provide most of the meals during the conference).

Space is limited, please register soon!

Here is a hyperlinked [list of confirmed speakers](#), whose talks will focus on their journeys into academia [challenges and opportunities], the importance of mentorship, and they will also present their latest research with the aim to build new collaborations! We are also making available a space for research posters to be displayed.

Concurrently with the Quebrando Barreras in STEM Conference, we partnered with the Latinas Future Lab 2050 to develop panels and offer a unique conference experience. Latina Futures will convene scholars from across California as well as from national and international institutions to participate in academic research talks, panels, networking activities, and discussion on strategies to broaden participation in STEM while promoting mentorship, community, belonging, and academic excellence.

The conference offers two unique tracks:

- 1) The Quebrando Barreras track will serve as the general conference focused primarily on research talks in chemistry and biochemistry and related fields, and
- 2) The Latina Futures track will provide conference programming with a thematic focus on the Latina STEM experience.

I'm reaching out to share an opportunity that your students may be interested in! We work at Bridge to Enter Advanced Mathematics (beammath.org), a non-profit focused on providing pathways into STEM for students from low-income, low-access backgrounds. Our students are 6th and 7th grade students from Los Angeles.

We're looking for undergraduate students who would be interested in a summer job as summer camp counselors and teaching assistants. These roles are great for individuals who are interested in working directly with middle schoolers to help support and guide them as they build confidence, independence, and community around a love for math! Camp Counselors will TA courses, run fun activities, run community events, and support student travel to/from the site daily. Our Counselors also take a course on pedagogy to support their own growth and development! If you have any students that fit this description, we would love for you to share this message with them.

The job description and application can be found here: https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/beam/jobs/4644108005?gh_src=svprded35us

Some Key Details:

- Hours: Counselors will average around 7.5 hours on duty per day from 8:30-4:30
- Dates/Location:
 - **Alliance College Ready Middle Academy 12 (Central Los Angeles)**
 - All Staff Pre-camp Training: 06/16 - 06/18 (Juneteenth Observed)
 - Camp: 06/22 - 07/24
 - Staff Wrap-up: 07/27 - 07/28
- Compensation:
 - \$19.50/hour
 - You are paid for travel time when traveling with groups of students to camp and back to their homes.
- Note that BEAM Discovery does NOT cover housing

Benefits:

- Lunch and snacks, with options for dietary restrictions on weekdays through all training and camp days.

- 2-3 staff dinners during camp to relax, connect, and celebrate together
- Limited, assigned parking is available (Los Angeles)

You can learn more about BEAM on our website, beammath.org. We would greatly appreciate it if you could forward this opportunity to students who may be interested in working with us this summer!

If you or your students have any questions, please feel free to reach out to us or our HR team (hiring@beammath.org)!